SHORT · LAKEHOUSE

What is a lakehouse?

A lakehouse keeps data in open files in low-cost storage and adds a table layer, such as Delta Lake, so one copy can power SQL, data engineering, and machine learning.

Key points

- A data lake is flexible storage for files such as CSV, JSON, and Parquet. Files alone are hard to trust as tables.
- A warehouse gives reliable tables for SQL and dashboards. It is usually more rigid, and data is often copied into it.
- A lakehouse combines the two: the files stay in lake storage, and the table layer adds reliability.
- In Databricks, one path is to save a DataFrame as a table, then query that table with SQL.

Tiny example

The Short's save-then-query shape. schema.table_name is a placeholder, not a recorded table.

```
# save a DataFrame as a table, then query it
dataframe.write.saveAsTable("schema.table_name")
spark.sql("SELECT * FROM schema.table_name")
```

Misconception check

A lakehouse is not just a folder of files, and it is not a second warehouse you must copy every table into. The files stay put. The table layer is what makes them reliable tables.

Remember

A lakehouse is lake storage with warehouse-style reliable tables.

The Short says you can try saving a table and querying it on a free Databricks account. That does not mean every Databricks feature is included.